

Positron tour

Welcome — positron-workshop-project — Presentation

New Open

Search

R 4.6.1 positron-workshop-project

EXPLORER

POSITRON-WORKSHOP-...
OUTLINE
TIMELINE

Welcome

Welcome to Positron

an IDE for data science from Posit

Environment setup

R

You have successfully set up R

Positron can discover R installations

A supported R is installed

/Library/Frameworks/R.framework/Versions/4.6/Resources/bin/R

The R installation is ready to use with Positron

CONSOLE

TERMINAL

PROBLEMS

OUTPUT

PORTS

DEBUG CONSOLE

~/work/positron-workshop-project

161MB

R 4.6.1 started.

>

SESSION

VIEWER

http://localhost:4242

Zoom: (Auto)

Hello, Quarto

Meet Quarto

Quarto enables you to weave together content and executable code into a finished document. To learn more about Quarto see [https://quarto.org](#).

Meet the penguins

The `penguins` data from the `palmerpenguins` package contains size measurements for 344 penguins from three species observed on three islands in the Palmer Archipelago, Antarctica.

The plot below shows the relationship between flipper and bill lengths of these penguins.



Flipper and bill length
Dimensions for penguins at Palmer Station, TER

Penguin species

- Adelie
- Chinstrap
- Gentoo

Let's create some objects.

```
adelie_penguins <- penguins [ >
  filter(species == "Adelie")

penguin_stats <- penguins [ >
  group_by(species) [ >
    summarise(
      avg_bill_length = mean(bill_length_mm, na.rm = TRUE),
      avg_flipper_length = mean(flipper_length_mm, na.rm = TRUE),
      count = n()
    )
  ]

heavy_penguins <- penguins [ >
  filter(body_mass_g > 5000) [ >
    select(species, island, sex, body_mass_g)
```

main*

Quarto: 1.10.18

Sign In

Show of hands

- I am completely or quite new to Positron.
- I'm somewhere in the middle.
- I use Positron as my main development environment.

What's your current experience level with Positron?

Select one answer

Totally or very new to Positron

22 votes **42%**

Somewhere in between

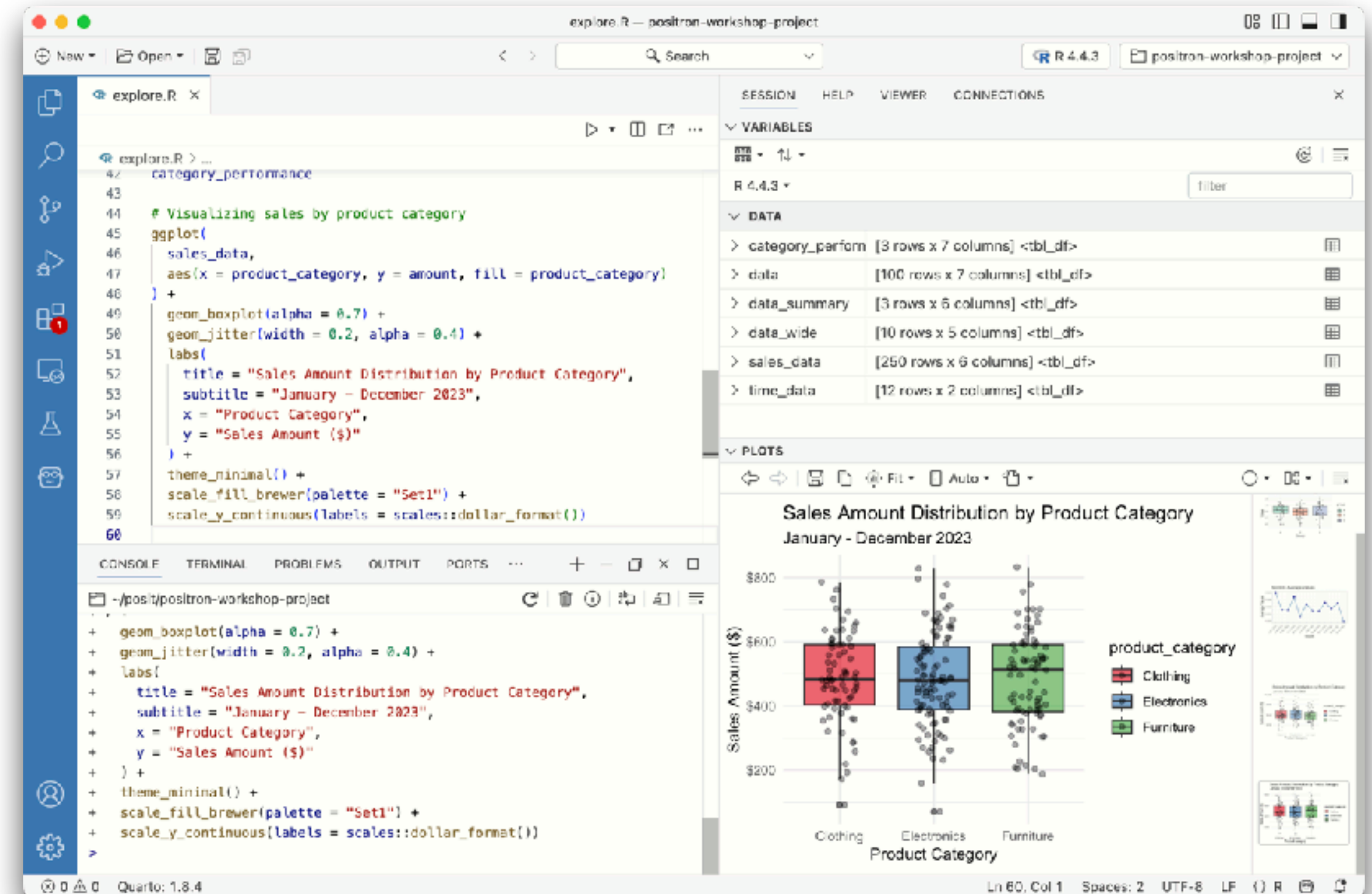
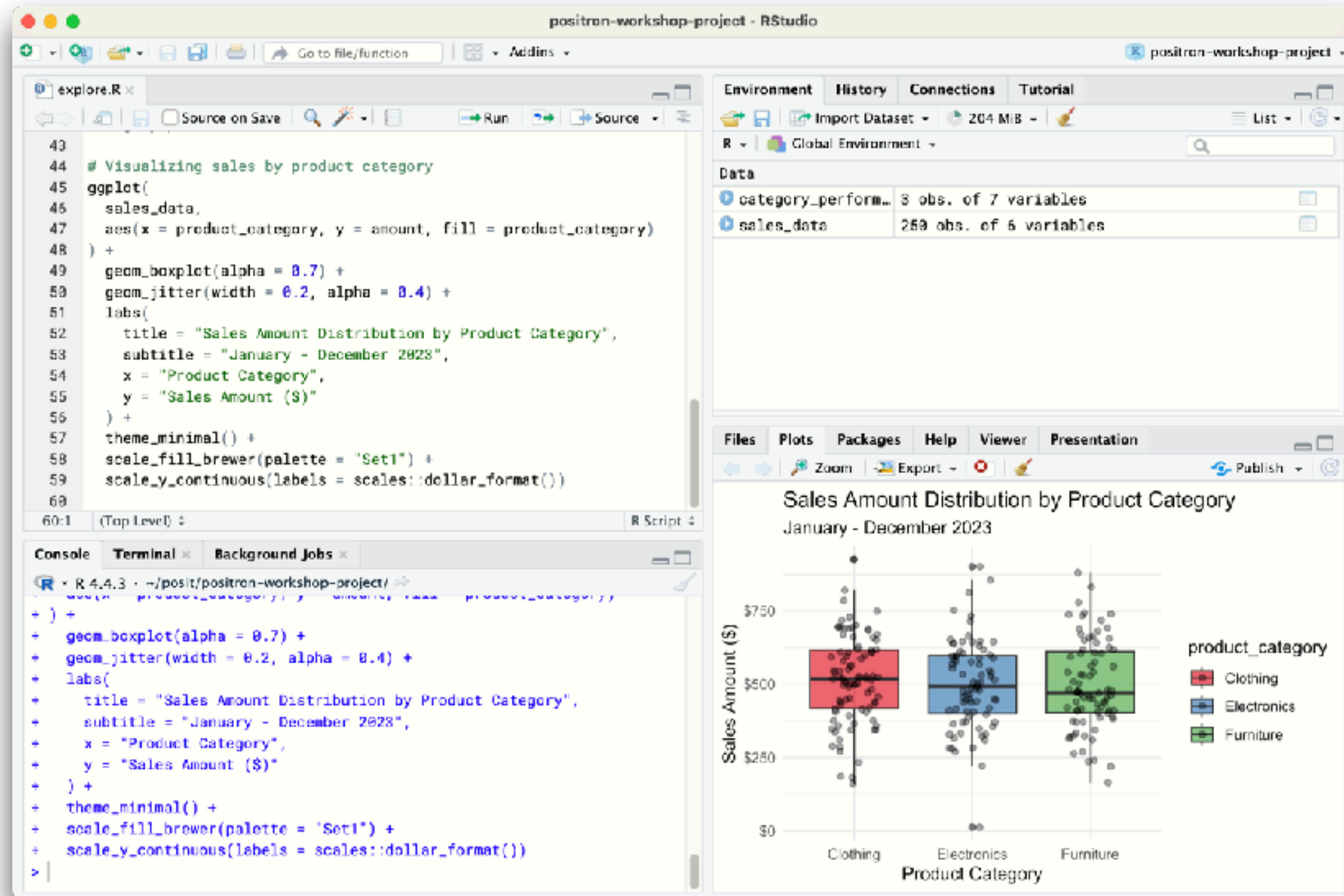
9 votes **17%**

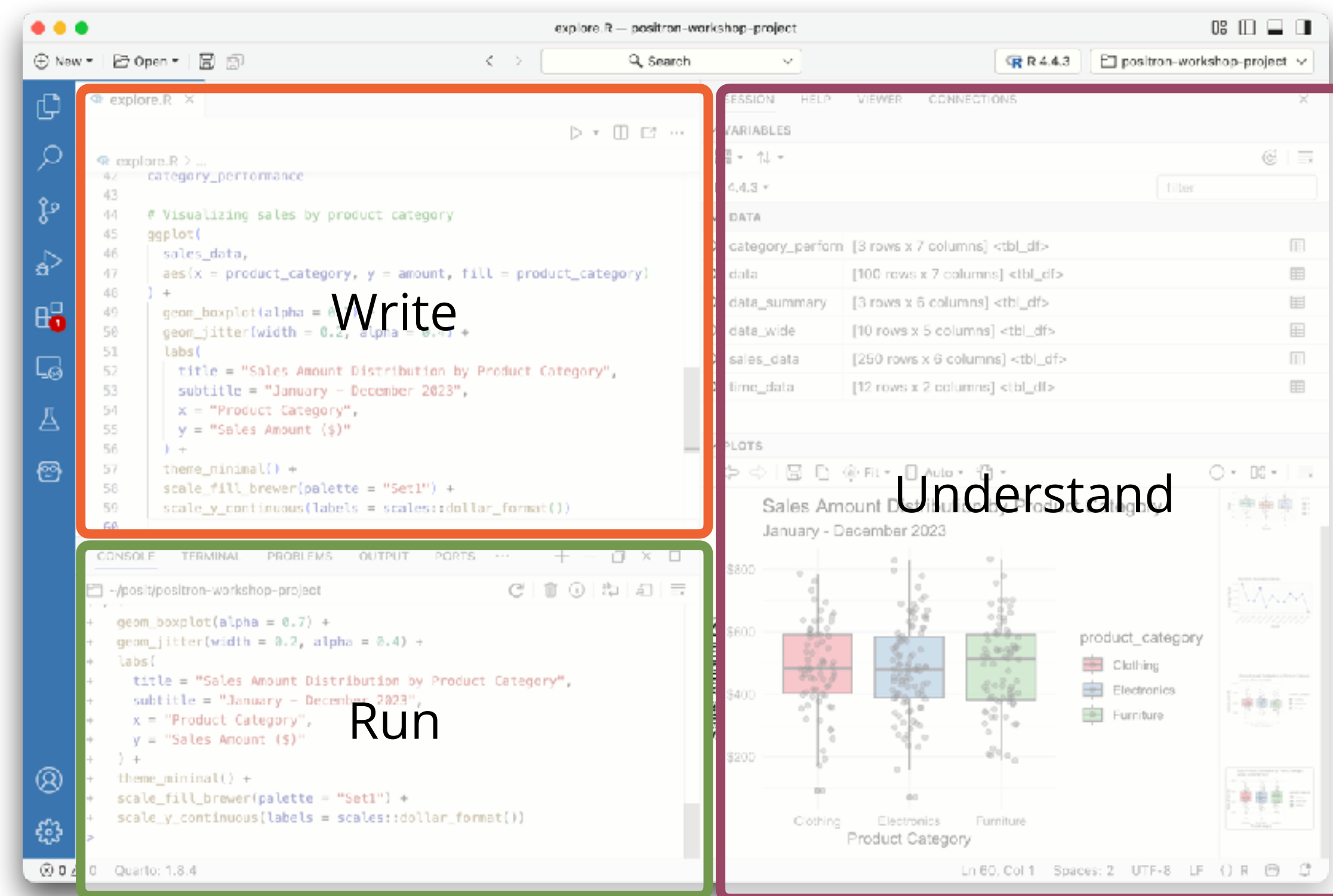
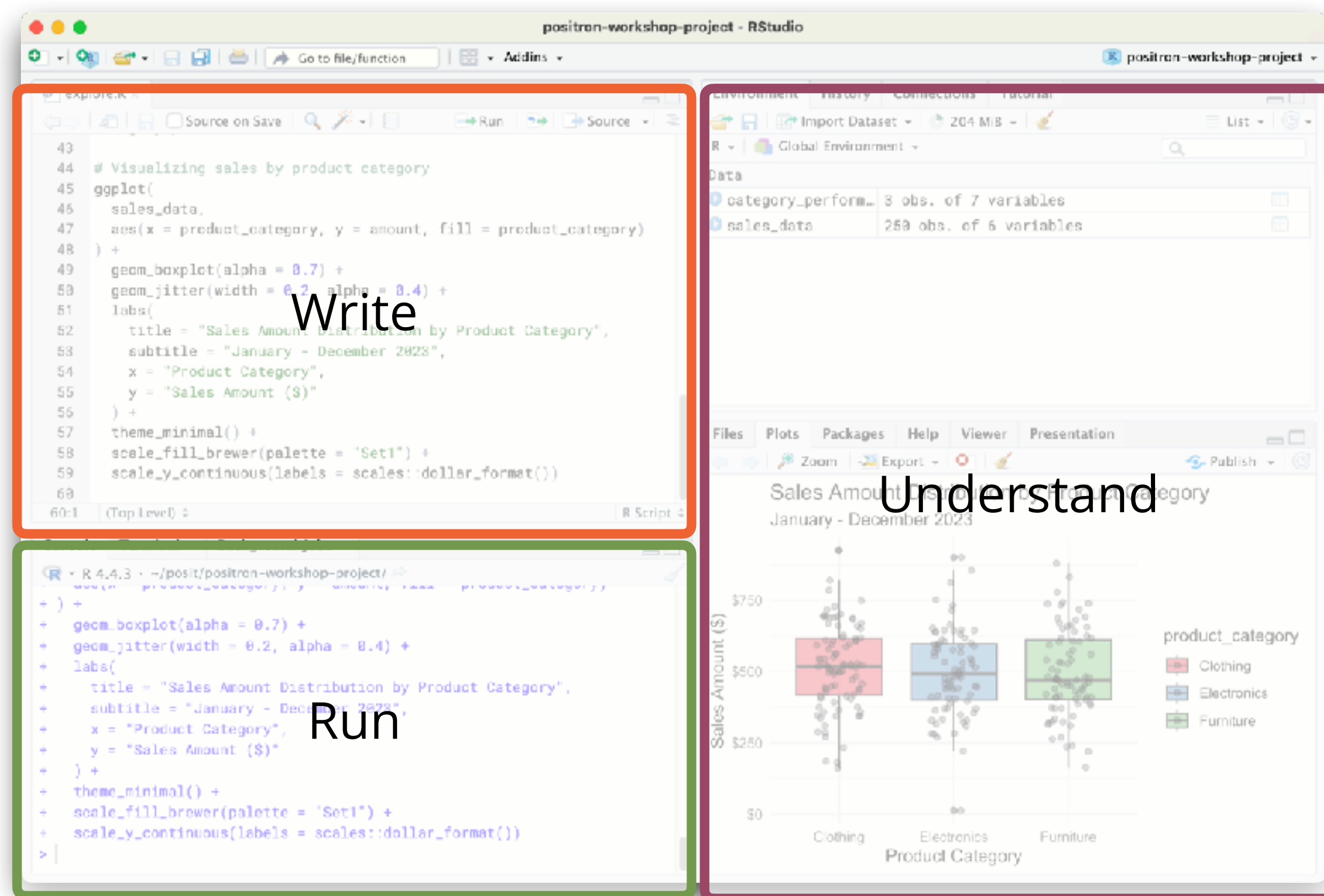
Positron is your main IDE

21 votes **40%**

Positron is ...

- A next-generation **data science** IDE
- Built for data exploration and writing code, with AI assistance (or not!)
- Familiar (RStudio-ish) and extensible (soft fork of VS Code)
- Multilingual data science: R and Python (built-in support), Julia (via community contributed extension)
- Plots, variables, console, help, viewer, data explorer, debugging, packages





Primary side bar

Editor

Activity bar

Secondary side bar

The image shows the Positron IDE interface with the following components:

- Activity bar:** Located on the left, it contains icons for switching between views: Explorer, Search, Source Control, Run and Debug, Remote Explorer, Extensions, Testing, and Settings.
- Primary side bar:** Contains the **EXPLORER** view showing the file structure of the 'positron-workshop-project'. The file 'hello.qmd' is selected.
- Editor:** The central area where the 'hello.qmd' file is open. It shows R code for data manipulation using dplyr.
- Secondary side bar:** Contains the **VARIABLES** and **PLOTS** views. The **VARIABLES** view shows the data structure of objects in the environment. The **PLOTS** view shows a scatter plot of 'Flipper and bill length' for penguins.
- Console:** Located at the bottom, it shows the output of the R code executed in the editor.

Code in the Editor:

```
## Meet the penguins

Let's create some objects.

{r}
adelie_penguins <- penguins
filter(species == "Adelie")

penguin_stats <- penguins
group_by(species)
summarize(
  avg_bill_length = mean(bill_length_mm, na.rm = TRUE),
  avg_flipper_length = mean(flipper_length_mm, na.rm = TRUE),
  count = n()
)

heavy_penguins <- penguins
filter(body_mass_g > 5000)
select(species, island, sex, body_mass_g)
```

Console Output:

```
~/work/positron-workshop-project 515MB
6 Adelie Torgersen 39.3 20.6 190
# i 3 more variables: body_mass_g <int>, sex <fct>, year <int>
> adelie_penguins <- penguins |>
+ filter(species == "Adelie")
> penguin_stats <- penguins |>
+ group_by(species) |>
+ summarize(
+   avg_bill_length = mean(bill_length_mm, na.rm = TRUE),
+   avg_flipper_length = mean(flipper_length_mm, na.rm = TRUE),
+   count = n()
+ )
> heavy_penguins <- penguins |>
+ filter(body_mass_g > 5000) |>
+ select(species, island, sex, body_mass_g)
>
```

VARIABLES View:

Object	Dimensions
adelie_penguins	[152 rows x 8 columns]
heavy_penguins	[61 rows x 4 columns]
penguin_stats	[3 rows x 4 columns]

PLOTS View:

ggplot2 scatter plot 2

Flipper and bill length
Dimensions for penguins at Palmer Station LTER

Bill length (mm)

Flipper length (mm)

Penguin species

- Adelie
- Chinstrap
- Gentoo

Panel

File explorer

Git

Extensions

Test explorer

Posit Assistant

Packages

The screenshot displays the Positron IDE interface for a project named "positron-workshop-project". The interface is divided into several panels:

- EXPLORER (Left):** Shows the file structure of the project, including files like `.vscode`, `hello_files`, `.gitignore`, `air-practice.R`, `fruit_avg_browser.R`, `fruit_avg_fixed.R`, `fruit_avg.R`, `fruit-debugging.R`, `fruit.csv`, `hello.html`, `hello.qmd` (selected), `positron-workshop-p...`, and `README.md`.
- Code Editor (Center):** Displays the content of `hello.qmd`. The code includes a title "## Meet the penguins", a comment "Let's create some objects.", and R code for creating data objects and summarizing statistics. The code is as follows:

```
## Meet the penguins

Let's create some objects.

{r}
adelie_penguins <- penguins |>
  filter(species == "Adelie")

penguin_stats <- penguins |>
  group_by(species) |>
  summarize(
    avg_bill_length = mean(bill_length_mm, na.rm = TRUE),
    avg_flipper_length = mean(flipper_length_mm, na.rm = TRUE),
    count = n()
  )

heavy_penguins <- penguins |>
  filter(body_mass_g > 5000) |>
  select(species, island, sex, body_mass_g)
```
- CONSOLE (Bottom Left):** Shows the output of the R code, including the first few rows of the `adelie_penguins` data frame and the results of the summarization and filtering operations.
- VARIABLES (Top Right):** Displays the memory usage of the variables in the environment. It shows `adelie_penguins` (152 rows x 8 columns), `heavy_penguins` (61 rows x 4 columns), `penguin_stats` (3 rows x 4 columns), and `penguins` (344 rows x 8 columns).
- PLOTS (Bottom Right):** Displays a scatter plot titled "Flipper and bill length" showing the relationship between flipper length and bill length for penguins at Palmer Station LTER. The plot is faceted by penguin species (Adelie, Chinstrap, Gentoo).

The status bar at the bottom indicates the current file is `main*`, the editor is in `Quarto: 1.10.18` mode, and the project is using `R 4.6.1`.

A metal paperclip is positioned at the top center of a piece of brown, textured paper. The paper has a slightly irregular, torn edge on the left side. The background is white.

Open the folder, not the file



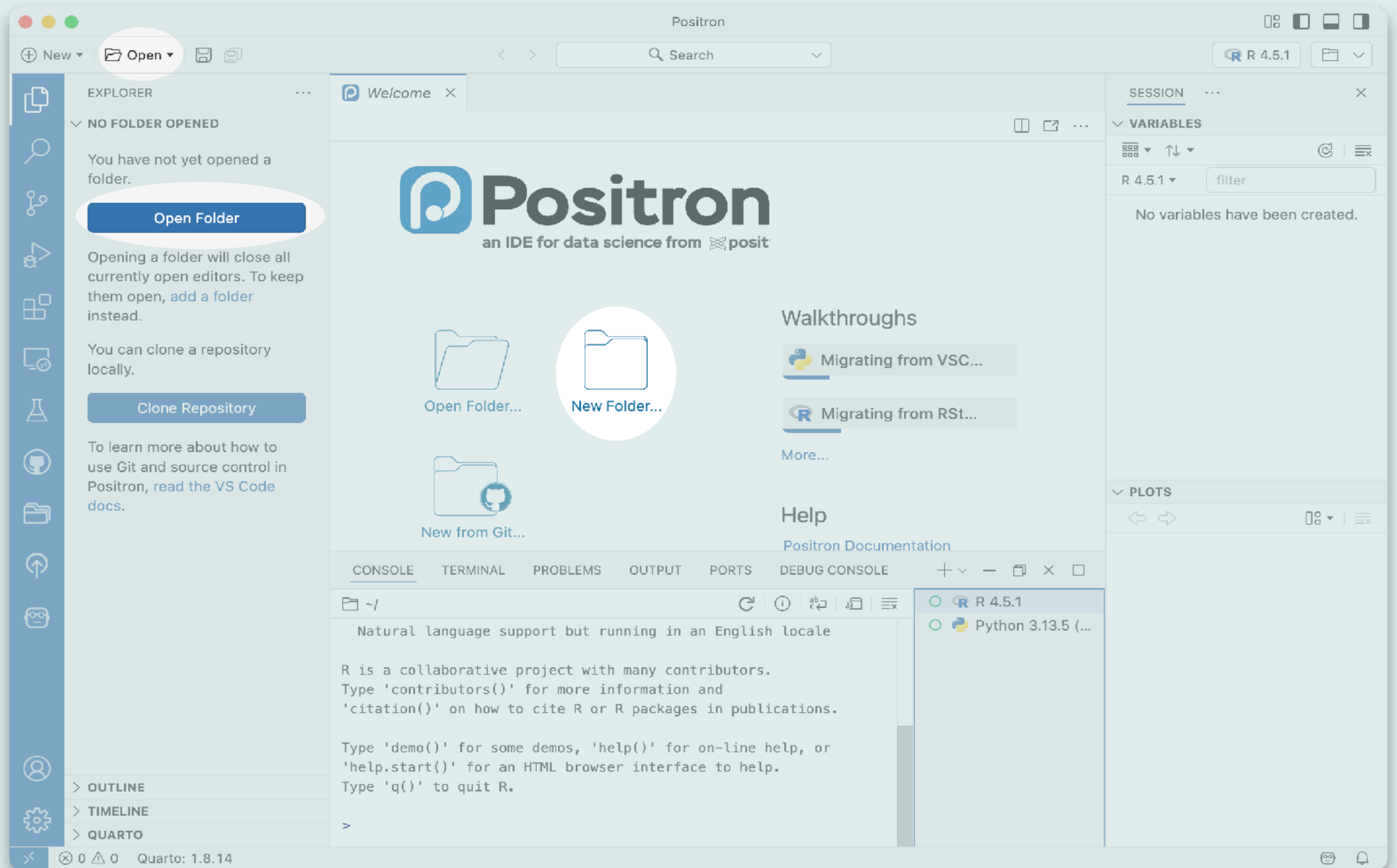
Workspace is a core concept in Positron

A **workspace** is just a **folder***

Similar to a **Project** in RStudio

Pro tip: work in a **folder** most (all?) of the time

* Or, at least, it can be and often is that simple



New

Open

Search

R 4.4.2

usethis

EXPLORER

OPEN EDITORS

create.R R

USETHIS

.github

.Rproj.user

.vscode

docs

inst

man

pkgdown

R

addin.R

air.R

author.R

badge.R

block.R

browse.R

ci.R

citation.R

code-of-conduct.R

course.R

coverage.R

cpp11.R

cran.R

create.R

data-table.R

data.R

description.R

directory.R

OUTLINE

TIMELINE

create.R

R > create.R > ...

1 #' Create a package or project

2 #'

3 #' @description

4 #' These functions create an R project:

5 #' * `create\_package()` creates an R package

6 #' * `create\_project()` creates a non-package project, i.e. a data analysis

7 #' project

8 #'

9 #' Both functions can be called on an existing project; you will be asked before

10 #' any existing files are changed.

11 #'

12 #' @inheritParams use_description

13 #' @param fields A named list of fields to add to `DESCRIPTION`, potentially

14 #' overriding default values. See [use_description()] for how you can set

15 #' personalized defaults using package options.

16 #' @param path A path. If it exists, it is used. If it does not exist, it is

17 #' created, provided that the parent path exists.

18 #' @param roxygen Do you plan to use roxygen2 to document your package?

19 #' @param rstudio If `TRUE`, calls [use_rstudio()] to make the new package or

20 #' project into an [RStudio

21 #' Project](https://r-pkgs.org/workflow101.html#sec-workflow101-rstudio-projects).

22 #' If `FALSE` and a non-package project, a sentinel `.here` file is placed so

23 #' that the directory can be recognized as a project by the

24 #' [here](https://here.r-lib.org) or

CONSOLE

TERMINAL

PROBLEMS

TEST RESULTS

OUTPUT

PORTS

~/rrr/usethis

> |

SESSION

VARIABLES

R 4.4.2

filter

No variables have been created.

PLOTS

main

0 ↓ 1 ↑

0 0

usethis

Quarto: 1.7.31

Ln 1, Col 1

Spaces: 2

UTF-8

LF

R



Do you trust the authors of the files in this folder?

Positron provides features that may automatically execute files in this folder.

If you don't trust the authors of these files, we recommend to continue in restricted mode as the files may be malicious. See [our docs](#) to learn more.

~/tmp/positron-workshop-project

☐ Trust the authors of all files in the parent folder 'tmp'

No, I don't trust the authors

Browse folder in restricted mode

Yes, I trust the authors

Trust folder and enable all features

Ways to launch Positron in a specific folder

- *New Window* then *Open Folder*
- *Open Recent* list appears in various places and via `Ctrl + R`
- *Open with Positron* in context menu of Windows File Explorer
- In a terminal
 - `positron path/to/my/folder`
- Project Manager extension
- Use a launcher like Raycast or Alfred
- Positron docs: [Migrating from RStudio > The Rproj file](#)

hello.qmd — positron-workshop-project

New ▾ Open ▾ Search R 4.6.1 positron-workshop-project ▾

EXPLORER

- POSITRON-WORKSHOP-...
- > .vscode
- > hello_files
- ◆ .gitignore
- 🔗 air-practice.R
- 🔗 fruit_avg_browser.R
- 🔗 fruit_avg_fixed.R
- 🔗 fruit_avg.R
- 🔗 fruit-debugging.R
- 📄 fruit.csv
- 🔗 hello.html
- 🔗 hello.qmd M
- 📁 positron-workshop-p...
- 📄 README.md

hello.qmd

```
19 ## Meet the penguins
44
45
46 Let's create some objects.
47
48 >Run Cell | Run Above
49 ```{r}
50 adelie_penguins <- penguins |>
51   filter(species == "Adelie")
52
53 penguin_stats <- penguins |>
54   group_by(species) |>
55   summarize(
56     avg_bill_length = mean(bill_length_mm, na.rm = TRUE),
57     avg_flipper_length = mean(flipper_length_mm, na.rm = TRUE),
58     count = n()
59   )
60
61 heavy_penguins <- penguins |>
62   filter(body_mass_g > 5000) |>
63   select(species, island, sex, body_mass_g)
```

CONSOLE

```
~/work/positron-workshop-project
6 Adelie Torgersen 39.3 20.6
# i 3 more variables: body_mass_g <int>, sex <fct>, year <int>
> adelie_penguins <- penguins |>
+ filter(species == "Adelie")
> penguin_stats <- penguins |>
+ group_by(species) |>
+ summarize(
+   avg_bill_length = mean(bill_length_mm, na.rm = TRUE),
+   avg_flipper_length = mean(flipper_length_mm, na.rm = TRUE),
+   count = n()
+ )
> heavy_penguins <- penguins |>
+ filter(body_mass_g > 5000) |>
+ select(species, island, sex, body_mass_g)
```

NEW FOLDER FROM TEMPLATE...

NEW FOLDER FROM GIT...

OPEN FOLDER...

OPEN FOLDER IN NEW WINDOW...

CLOSE FOLDER

- ~/work/modern-r-workflow
- ~/work/glue
- ~/work/positron-workshop-project
- ~/work/2026_raukr-positron-ai-pkg-dev
- ~/tmp/libminer
- ~/work/positron/extensions/positron-r/resources/testing/r.pkg.test.explorer.fixture
- ~/work/system-setup
- ~/work/aaaaa
- ~/work/devtools
- /var/folders/lr/gj14p5c543v8fc_hmdtyypk80000gn/T/vscsmoke/test-files

CLEAR RECENTLY OPENED

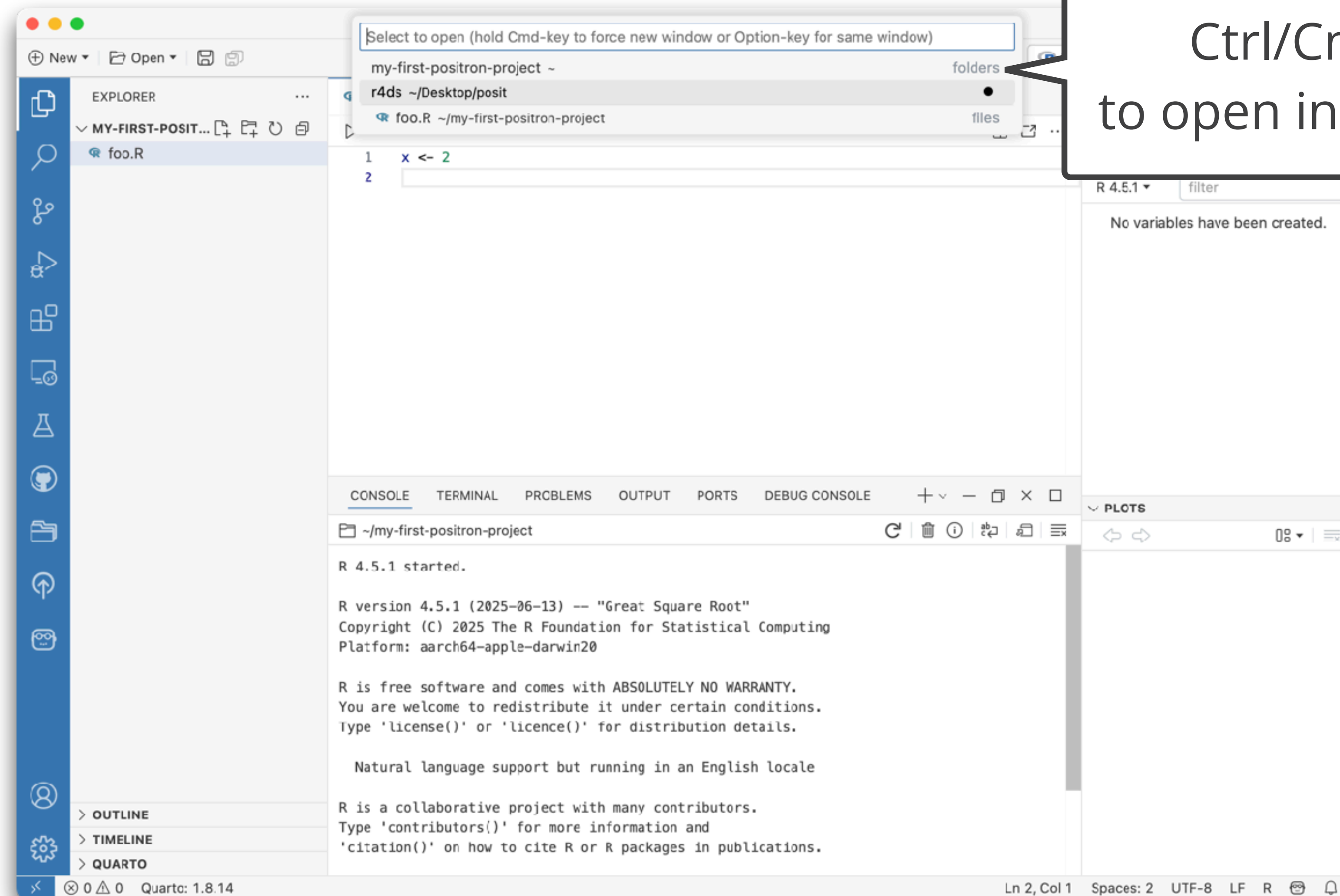
Flipper and bill length
Dimensions for penguins at Palmer Station LTER

ggplot2 scatte...

Click to
reveal
menu

Click to
open in
new
window

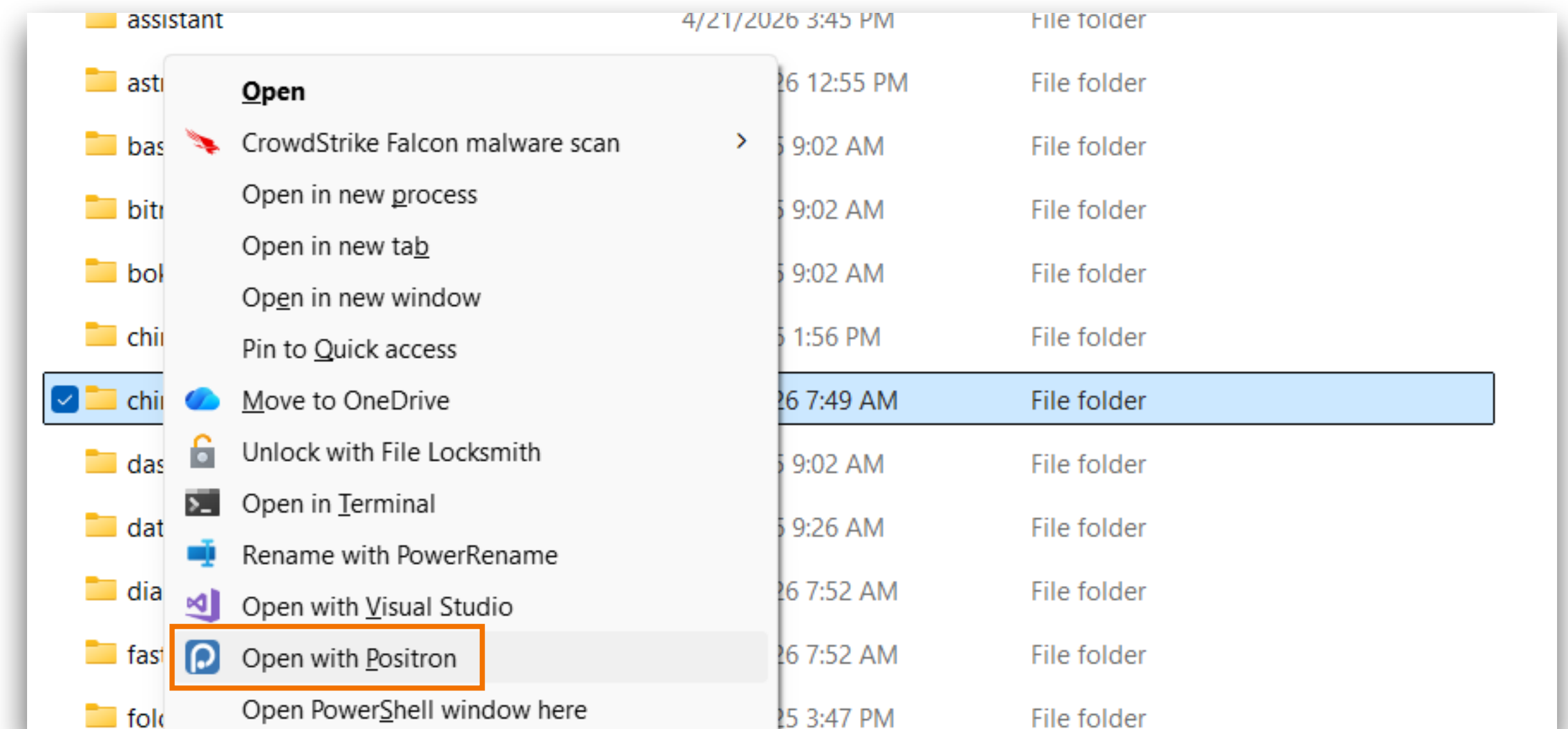
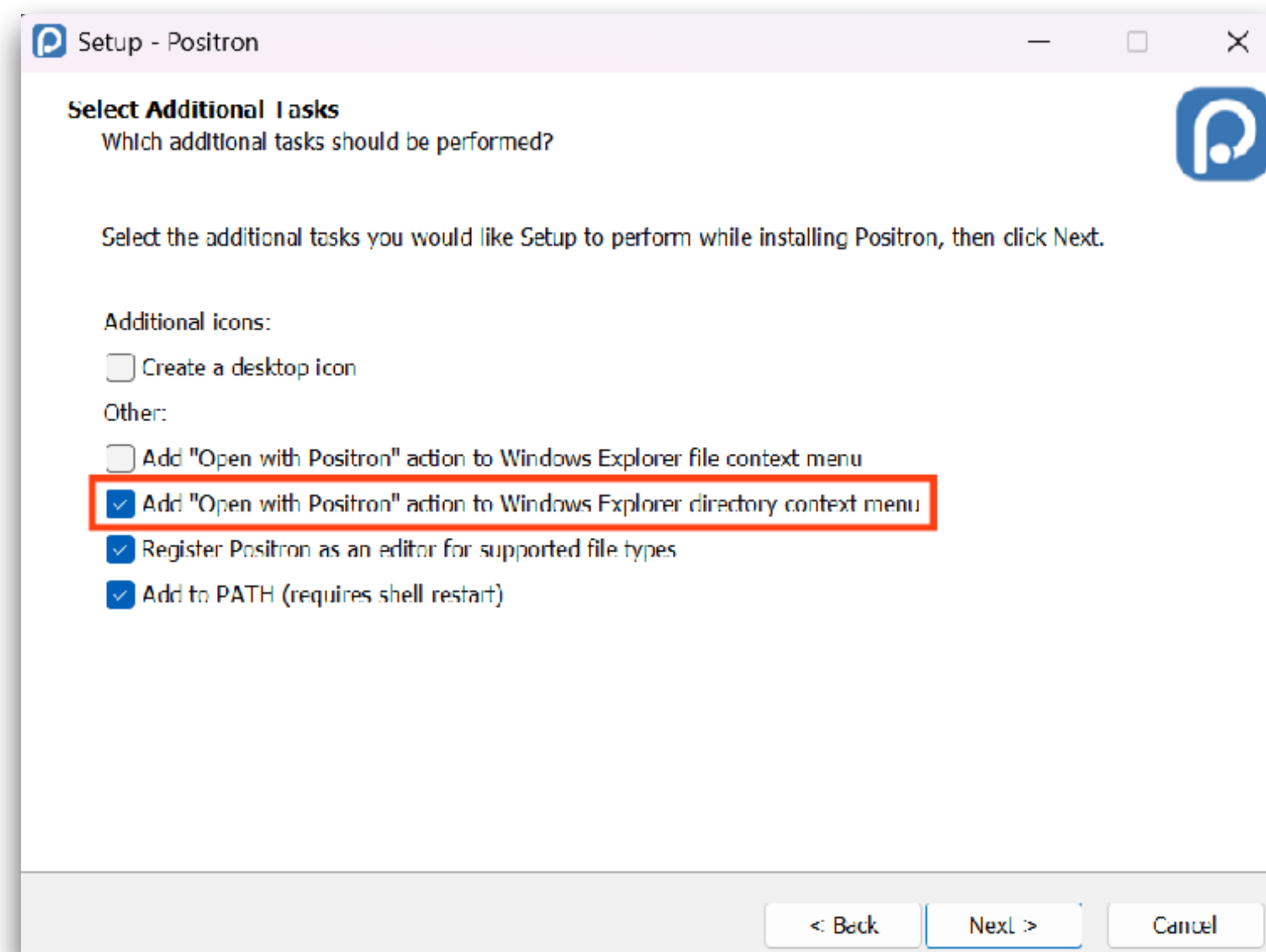
Ctrl + R



Windows: Launch from File Explorer

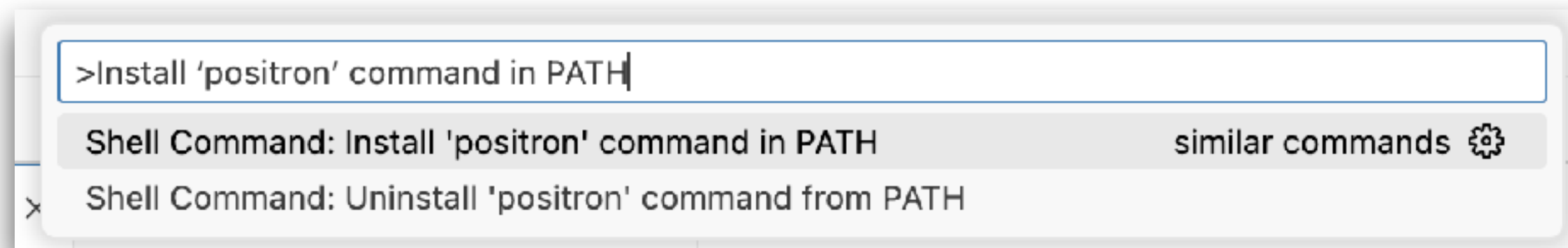
Setup: When installing Positron, enable context menu integration in *Setup > Select Additional Tasks* by checking the box to “Open with Positron”.

In File Explorer: Shift + right-click on a folder and select “Open with Positron” from the context menu.



Mac OS: Launch from Finder or Terminal

Setup: Add Positron to your **PATH** via the Command Palette by pressing Cmd+Shift+P to open the palette and typing *Install 'positron' command in PATH*.



In Finder: Right-click on a folder and select "New Terminal at Folder". Then in that terminal, do this:

```
positron .
```

In Terminal:

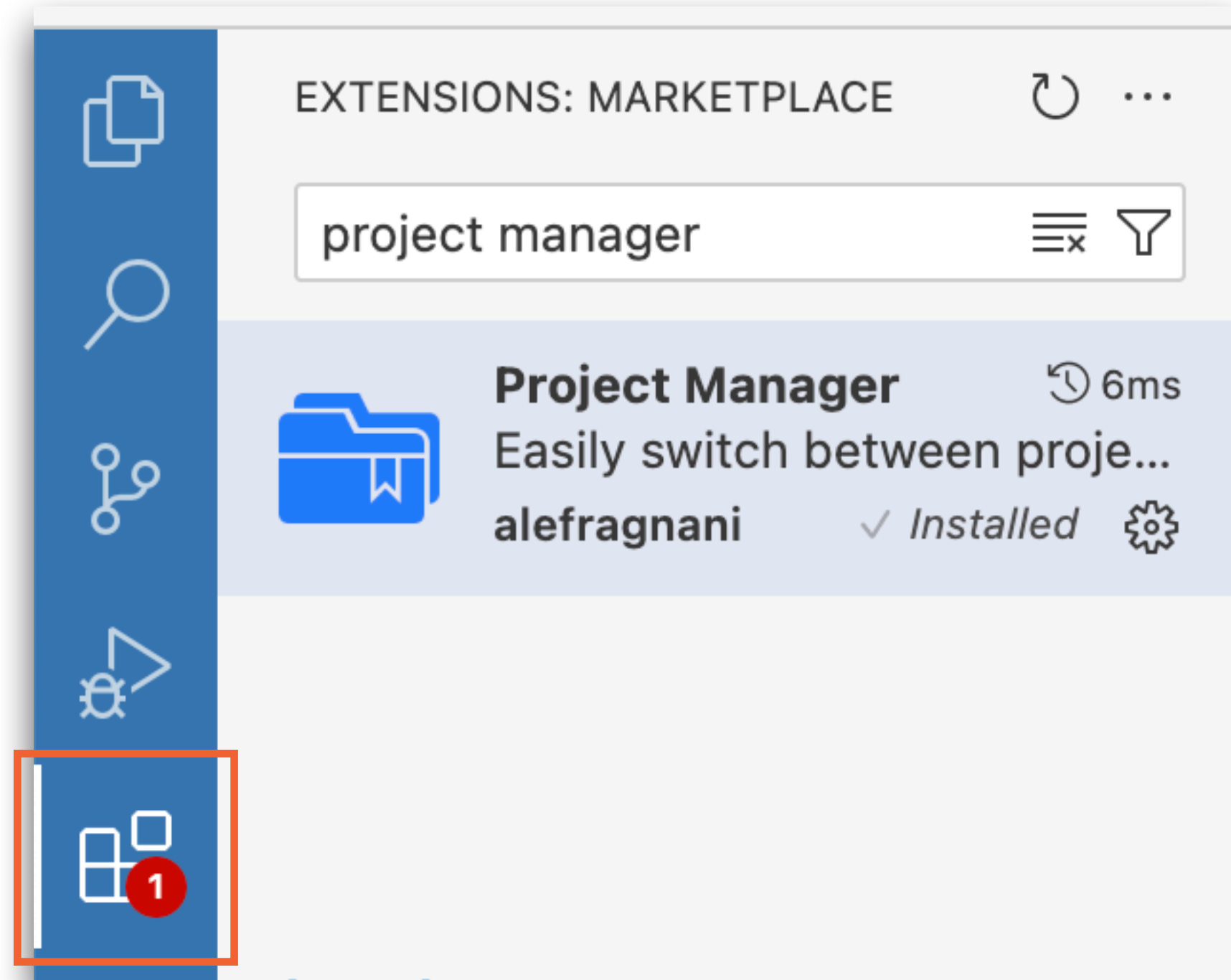
```
positron path/to/my/folder
```

or

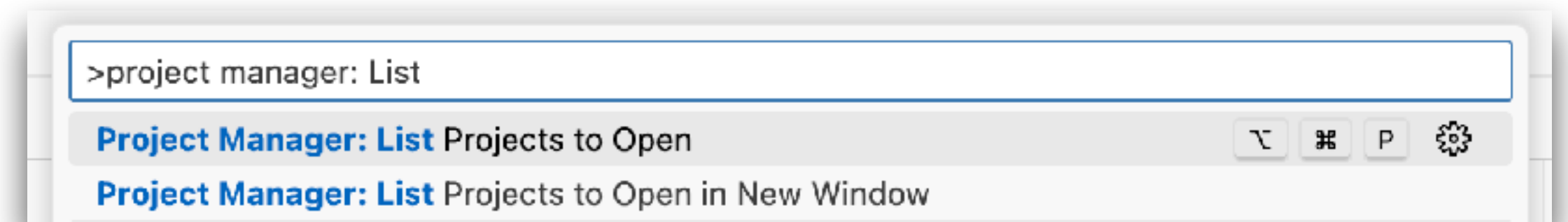
```
cd path/to/my/folder  
positron .
```

Launch from the Project Manager extension

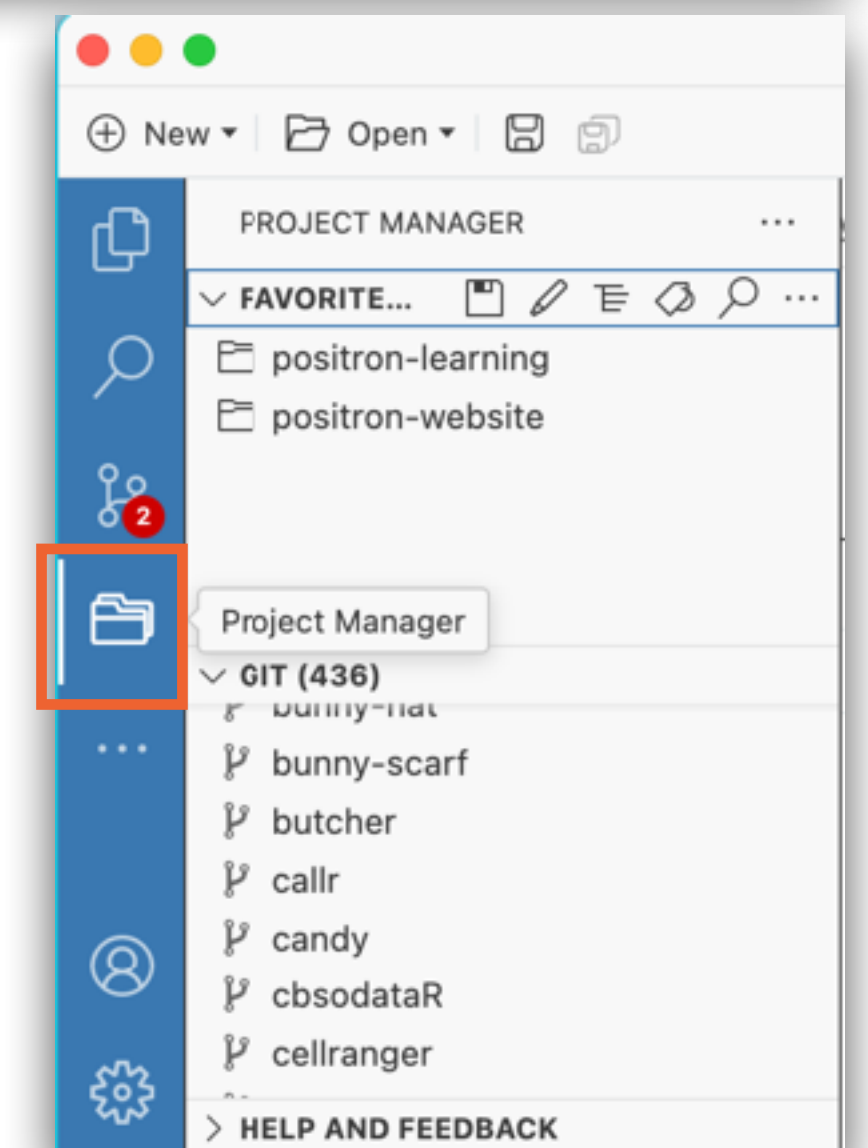
Setup: Install extension from Open VSX Registry.



In the Command Palette: Type *Project Manager: List projects to open* which gives you a nice searchable UI in the command palette.

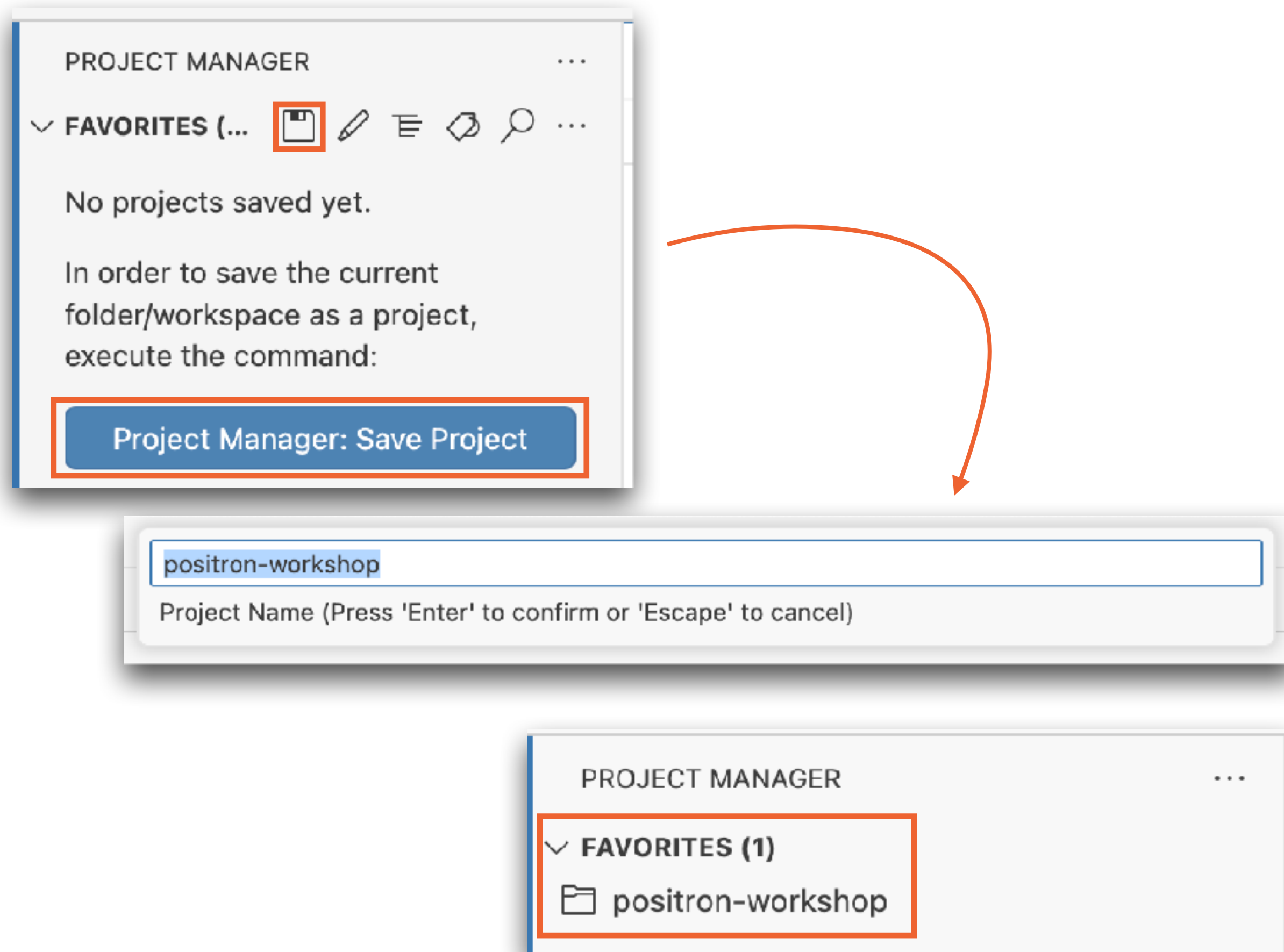


In the Activity Bar:
Click on extension icon.

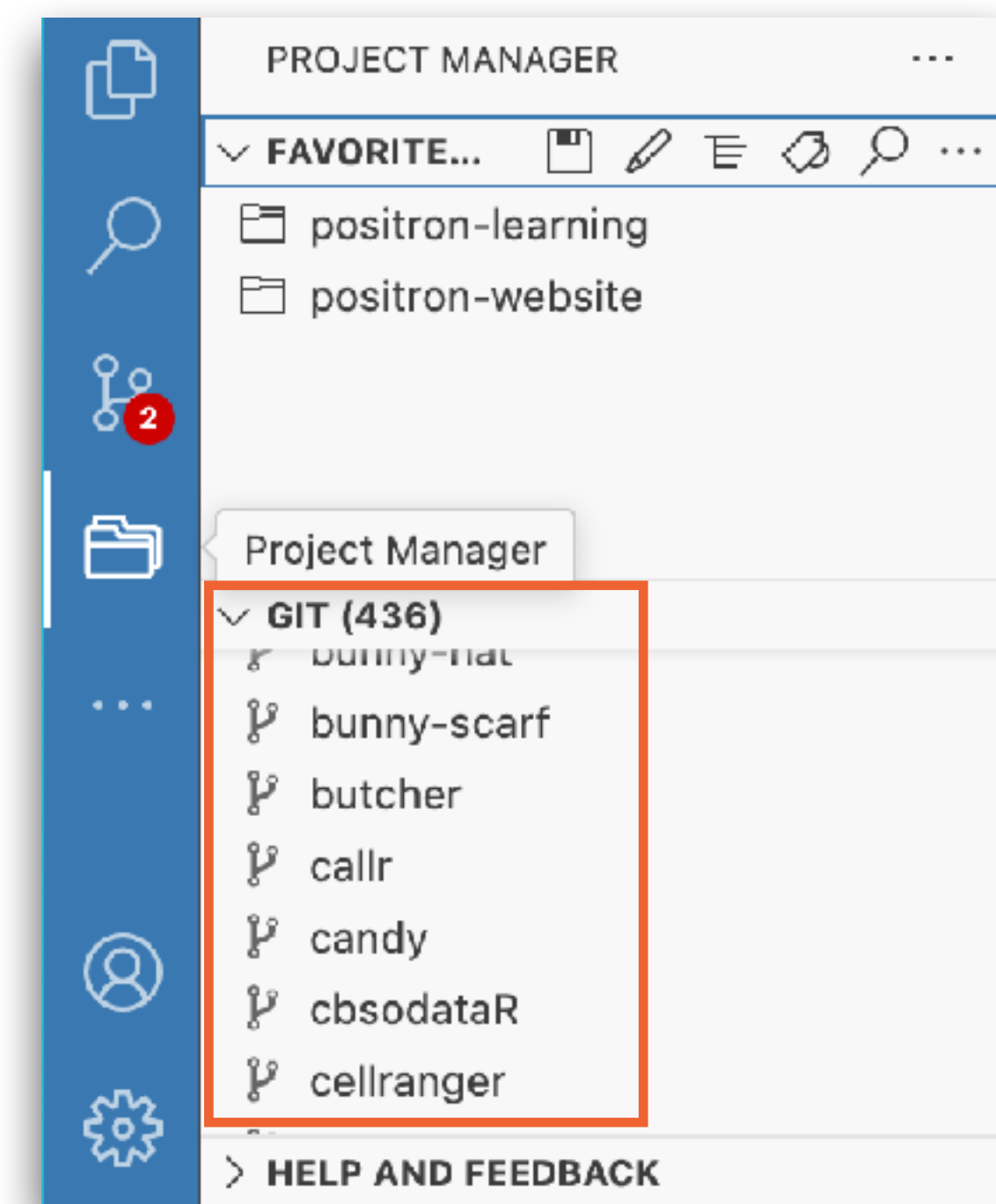


Making your folders known to Project Manager

Favorites: Explicitly save specific folders as favorites.

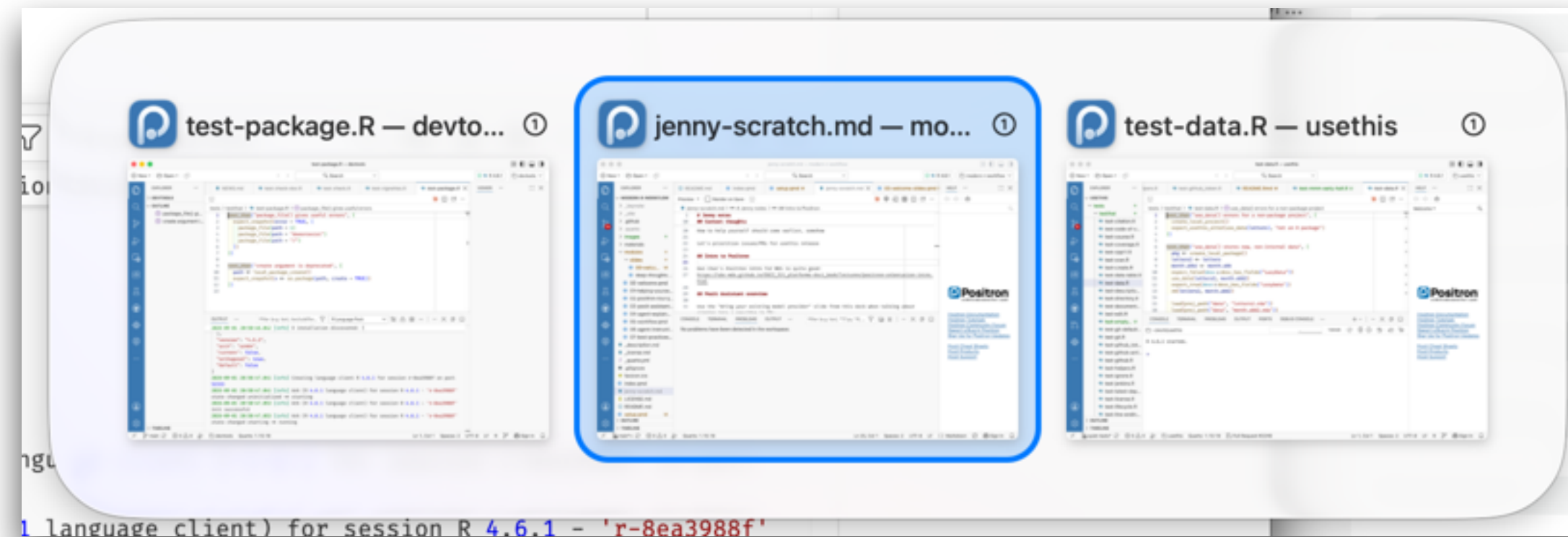


Git: Tell the extension about specific folders where you tend to keep Git repositories — any subfolder of these base folders that is also a Git repo is automatically treated as a project.

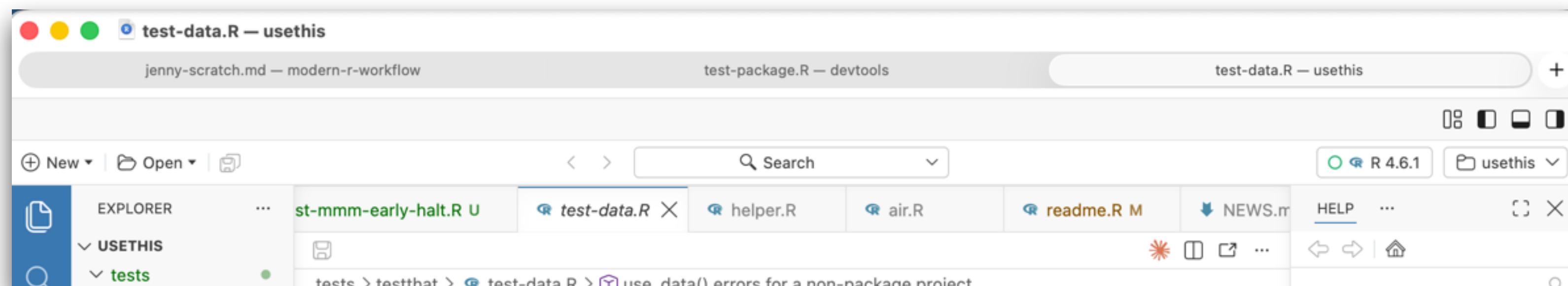


Wrangling multiple open folders in macOS

- AltTab = a Windows-style switcher among windows for one app



- Set window.nativeTabs: true in Positron user settings*



* In Positron, this does not require you to set "Prefer tabs when opening documents" at the OS-level.

R 4.4.3

R 4.5.3

R 4.6.1



New ▾Open ▾Save

EXPLORER

OPEN EDITORS

USETHIS

R

OUTLINE

TIMELINE

create.R

create.R R

.github

.Rproj.user

.vscode

docs

inst

man

pkgdown

addin.R

air.R

author.R

badge.R

block.R

browse.R

ci.R

citation.R

code-of-conduct.R

course.R

coverage.R

cpp11.R

cran.R

create.R

data-table.R

data.R

description.R

directory.R

create.R

R > create.R

1 #' Create a package or project

2 #'

3 #' @description

4 #' These functions create an R project:

5 #' * `create\_package()` creates an R package

6 #' * `create\_project()` creates a non-package project, i.e. a data analysis

7 #' project

8 #'

9 #' Both functions can be called on an existing project; you will be asked before

10 #' any existing files are changed.

11 #'

12 #' @inheritParams use_description

13 #' @param fields A named list of fields to add to `DESCRIPTION`, potentially

CONSOLE

TERMINAL

PROBLEMS

OUTPUT

PORTS

DEBUG CONSOLE

~/rrr/usethis

R is free software and comes with ABSOLUTELY NO WARRANTY.
You are welcome to redistribute it under certain conditions.
Type 'license()' or 'licence()' for distribution details.

Natural language support but running in an English locale

R is a collaborative project with many contributors.
Type 'contributors()' for more information and
'citation()' on how to cite R or R packages in publications.

Type 'demo()' for some demos, 'help()' for on-line help, or
'help.start()' for an HTML browser interface to help.
Type 'q()' to quit R.

> devtools::load_all()

i Loading usethis

>

main*

usethis

Quarto: 1.7.31

Ln 1, Col 1

Spaces: 2

UTF-8

LF

R

Select Interpreter Session

R 4.4.2 Currently Selected
/Library/Frameworks/R.framework/Versions/4.4-arm64/Resource...

Active Interpreter Sessions

New Interpreter Session...

R 4.4.2

usethis ▾

SESSION

HELP

...

×

New

Open

EXPLORER

OPEN EDITORS

create.R R

USETHIS

.github

.Rproj.user

.vscode

docs

inst

man

pkgdown

R

addin.R

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course.R

coverage.R

cpp11.R

cran.R

create.R

data-table.R

data.R

description.R

directory.R

OUTLINE

TIMELINE

1

2

3

4

5

6

7

8

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10

11

12

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14

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16

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23

24

Python 3.11.11 (Pyenv)

~/pyenv/versions/3.11.11/bin/python

Python 3.10.16 (Pyenv)

~/pyenv/versions/3.10.16/bin/python

Python 3.13.3 (Global)

/opt/homebrew/bin/python3

Python 3.9.6 (Global)

/usr/bin/python3

R 4.4.2

/Library/Frameworks/R.framework/Versions/4.4-arm64/Resources/bin/R

R 4.5.0

/Library/Frameworks/R.framework/Versions/4.5-arm64/Resources/bin/R

R 4.3.3

/Library/Frameworks/R.framework/Versions/4.3-arm64/Resources/bin/R

Pyenv

Global

System

#' overriding default values. See [use_description()] for how you can set

#' personalized defaults using package options.

#' @param path A path. If it exists, it is used. If it does not exist, it is

#' created, provided that the parent path exists.

#' @param roxygen Do you plan to use roxygen2 to document your package?

#' @param rstudio If `TRUE`, calls [use_rstudio()] to make the new package or

#' project into an [RStudio

#' Project](https://r-pkgs.org/workflow101.html#sec-workflow101-rstudio-projects).

#' If `FALSE` and a non-package project, a sentinel `.here` file is placed so

#' that the directory can be recognized as a project by the

#' [here](https://here.r-lib.org) or

CONSOLE

TERMINAL

PROBLEMS

TEST RESULTS

OUTPUT

PORTS

...

~/rrr/usethis

>

R 4.4.2

usethis

SESSION

VARIABLES

R 4.4.2

filter

No variables have been created.

PLOTS

main

0↓ 1↑

0 0

usethis

Quarto: 1.7.31

Ln 1, Col 1

Spaces: 2

UTF-8

LF

R

create.R — usethis

New

Open

<

>

Search

R 4.4.2

usethis

EXPLORER

OPEN EDITORS

create.R R

USETHIS

> .github

> .Rproj.user

> .vscode

> docs

> inst

> man

> pkgdown

R

addin.R

air.R

author.R

badge.R

block.R

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course.R

coverage.R

cpp11.R

cran.R

create.R

data-table.R

data.R

description.R

directory.R

OUTLINE

TIMELINE

create.R

R > create.R > ...

1 #' Create a package or project

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4 #' These functions create an R project:

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7 #' project

8 #'

9 #' Both functions can be called on an existing project; you will be asked before

10 #' any existing files are changed.

11 #'

12 #' @inheritParams use_description

13 #' @param fields A named list of fields to add to `DESCRIPTION`, potentially

14 #' overriding default values. See [use_description()] for how you can set

15 #' personalized defaults using package options.

16 #' @param path A path. If it exists, it is used. If it does not exist, it is

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22 #' If `FALSE` and a non-package project, a sentinel `.here` file is placed so

23 #' that the directory can be recognized as a project by the

24 #' [here](https://here.r-lib.org) or

CONSOLE

TERMINAL

PROBLEMS

TEST RESULTS

OUTPUT

PORTS

...

~/rrr/usethis

>

SESSION

VARIABLES

R 4.4.2

filter

No variables have been created.

PLOTS

main

0 ↓ 1 ↑

0 0

usethis

Quarto: 1.7.31

Ln 1, Col 1

Spaces: 2

UTF-8

LF

R

R 4.4.2

R 4.5.0

R 4.5.0

R 4.3.3



rig

Standalone tool to manage multiple R installations

Not part of Positron, but a great complement

Especially important for macOS users

<https://github.com/r-lib/rig>



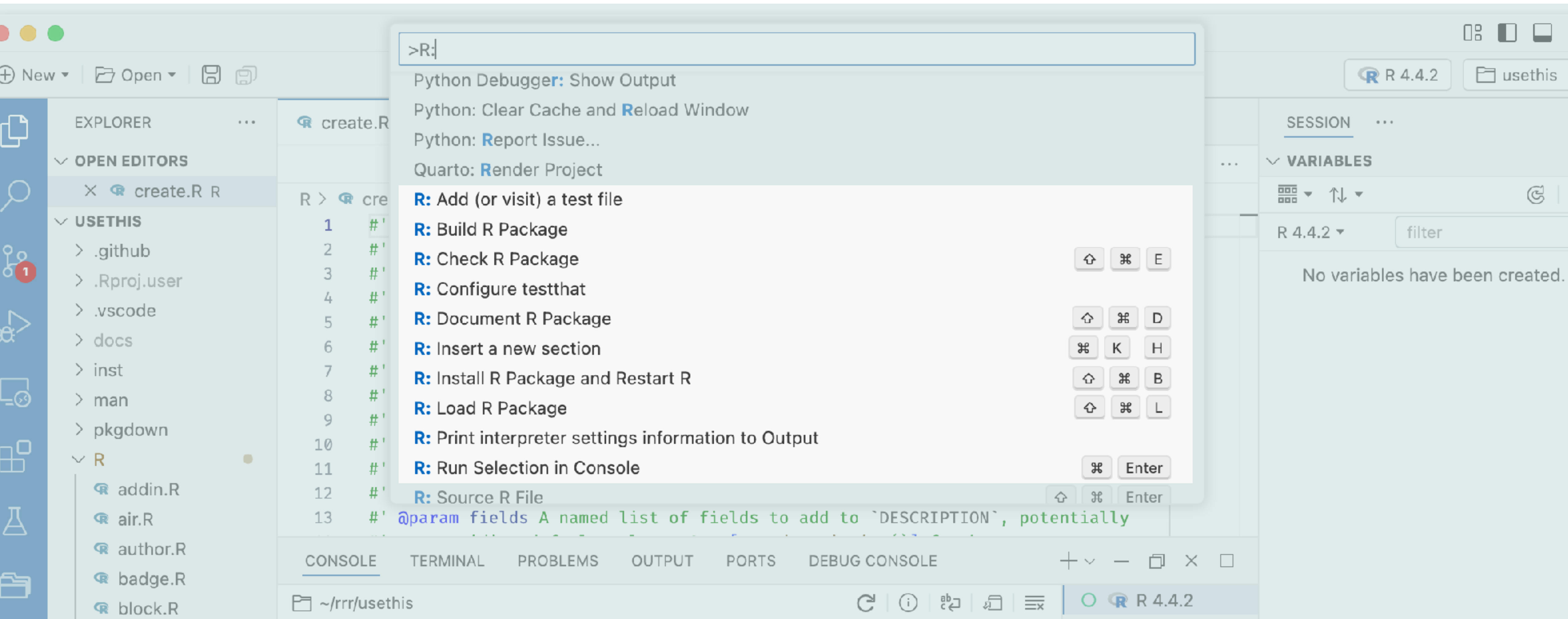
The

command palette

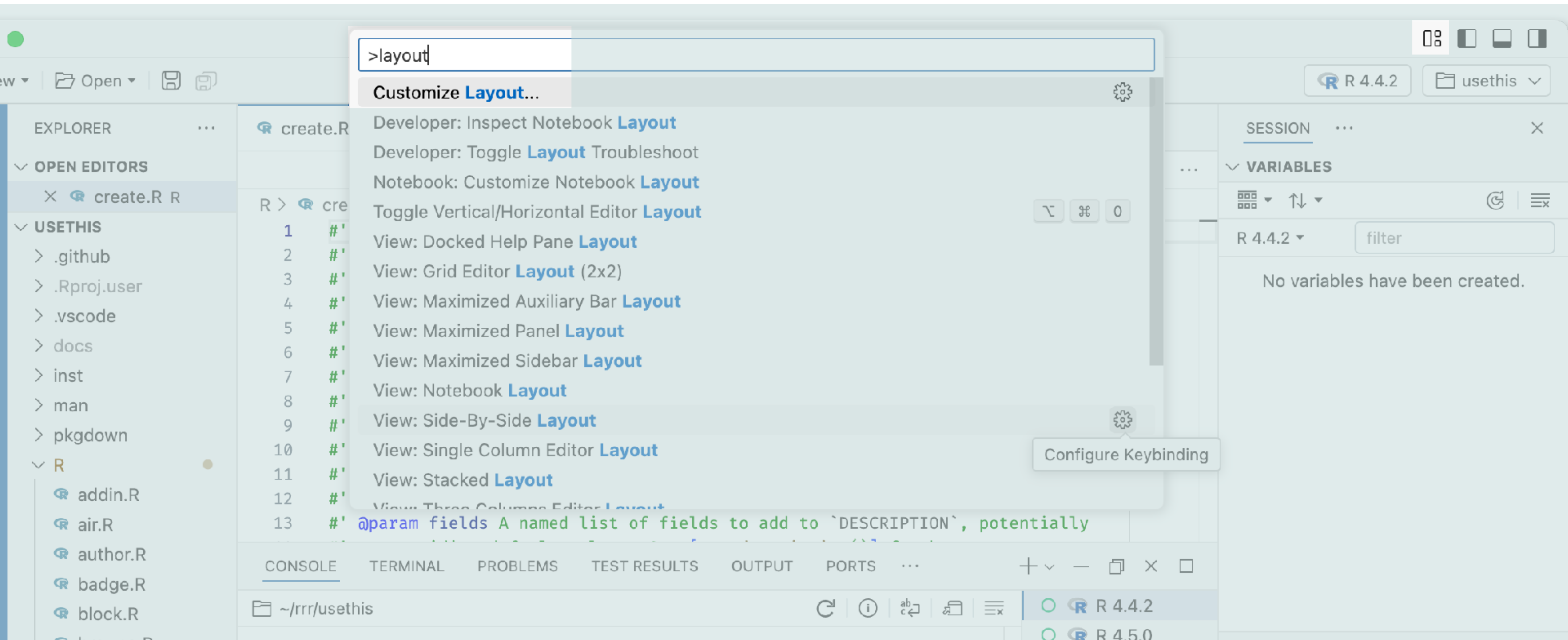
is a core concept in Positron

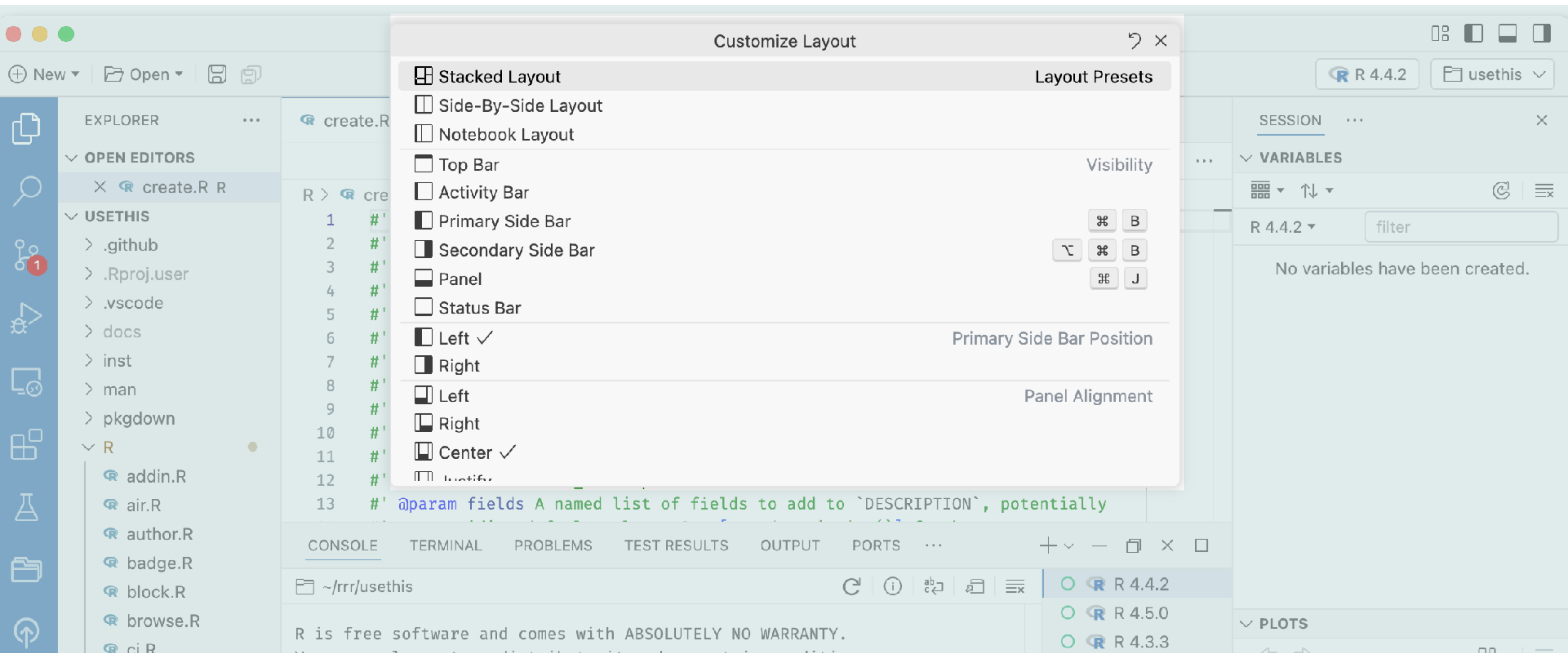
Ctrl/Cmd + Shift + P

Ctrl/Cmd + Shift + P

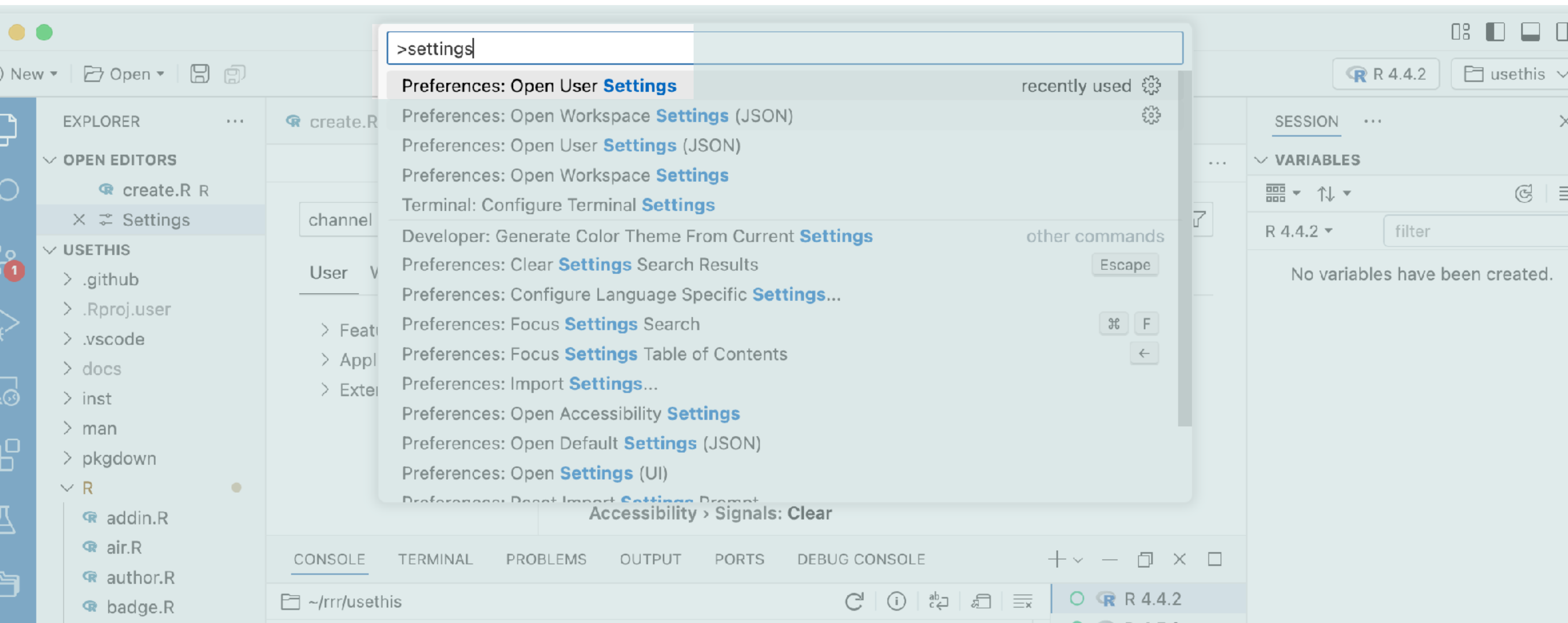


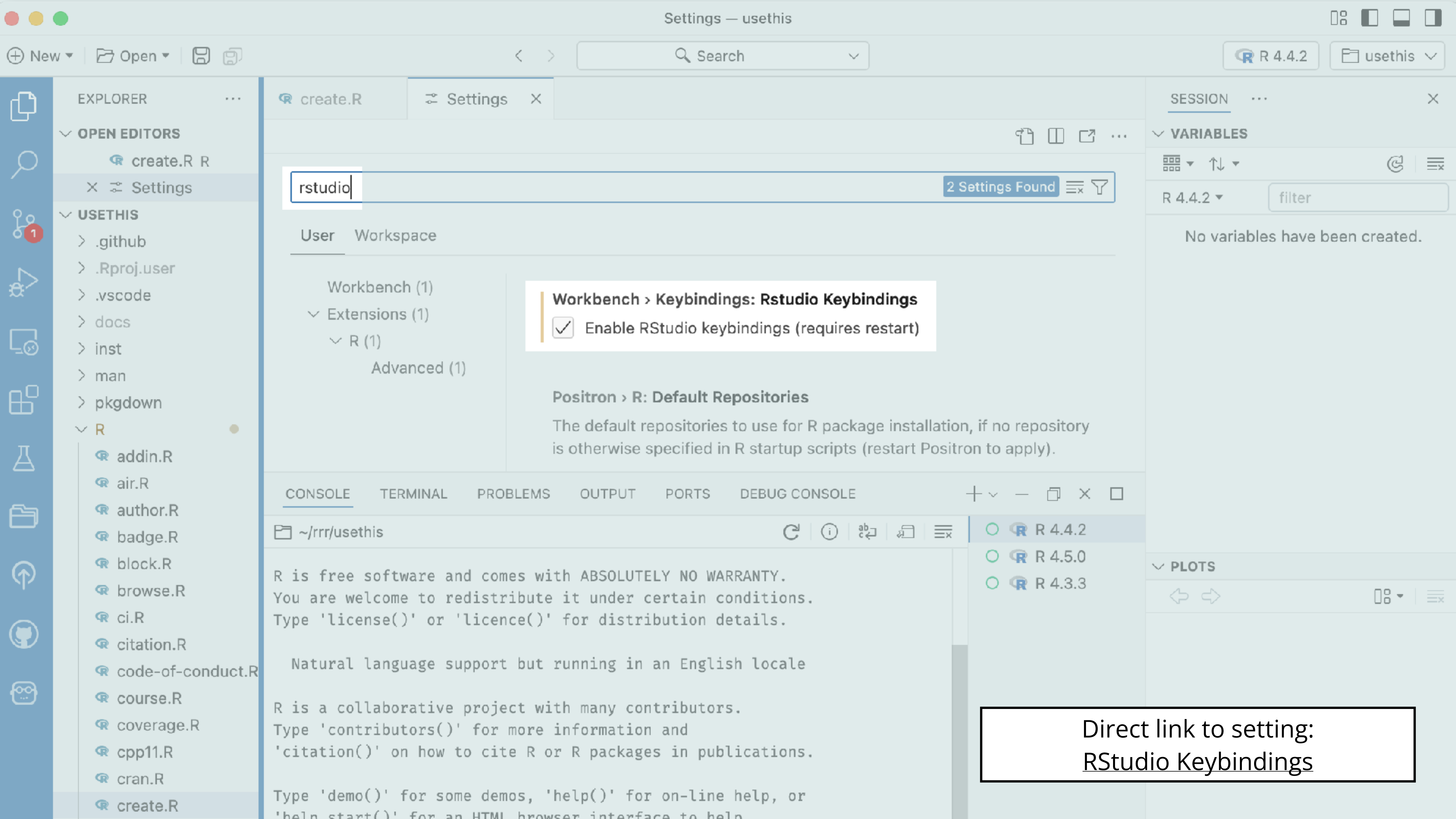
Ctrl/Cmd + Shift + P



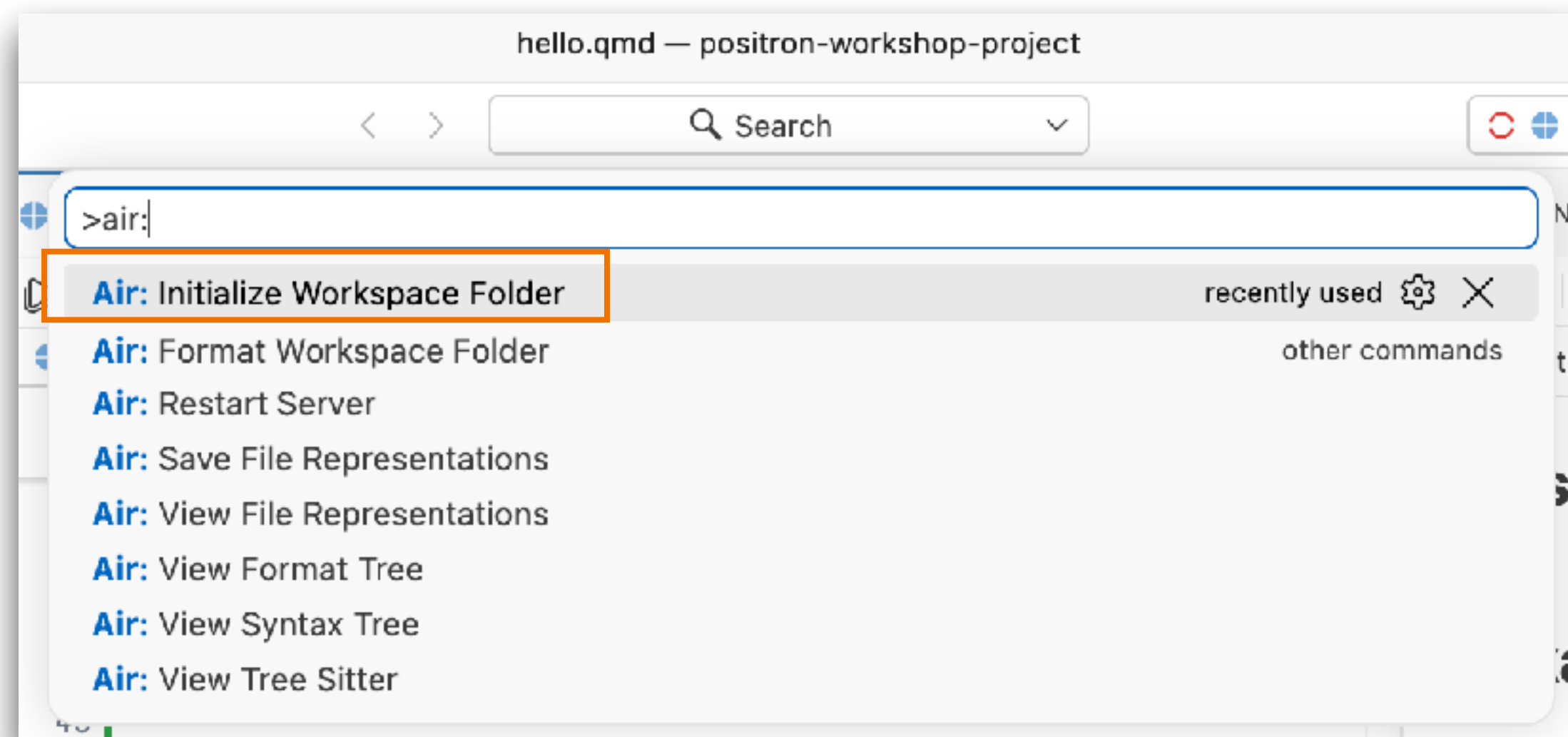


Ctrl/Cmd + Shift + P



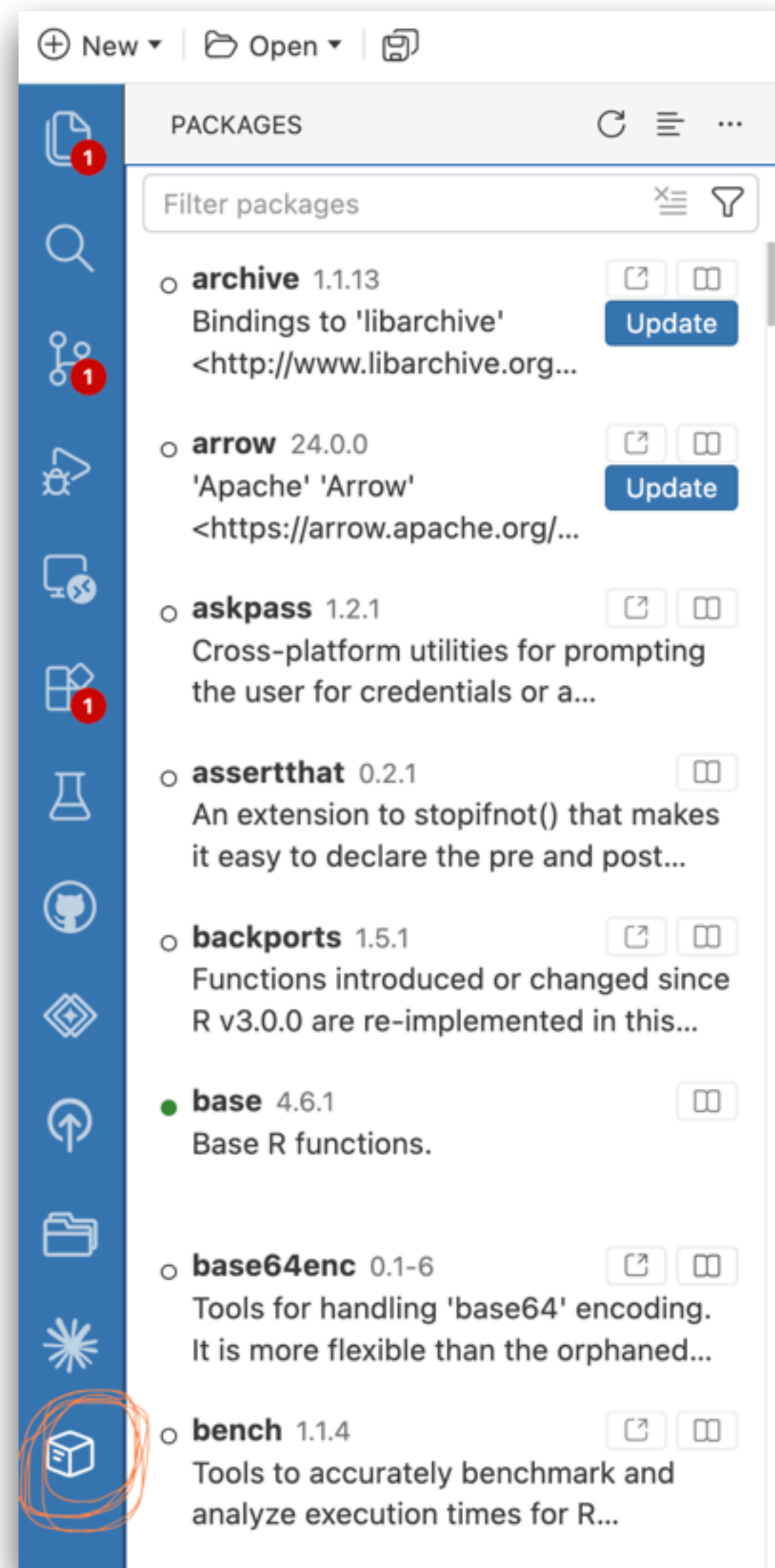


Direct link to setting:
RStudio Keybindings



- Air formatter for R
- posit-dev.github.io/air
- *Air: Initialize Workspace Folder* turns on "format on save" for R and Quarto

Recent developments



Packages pane debuted in the 2026.05 release

<https://positron.posit.co/packages-pane.html>

PACKAGES

Filter packages

decorations for C++...

o desc 1.4.3
Tools to read, write, create, and manipulate...

● devtools 2.5.2
Collection of package development tools.

o diffobj 0.3.8
Generate a colored diff of two R objects for an intuitiv...

Package: devtools — positron-workshop-project

hello.qmd M Package: devtools X

SESSION CONNECTIONS HELP

R: Tools to Make Developing R Packages Easier

Tools to Make Developing R Packages Easier

devtools

Documentation for package 'devtools' version 2.5.2

- [DESCRIPTION file](#)
- [User guides, package vignettes and other documentation](#)
- [Package NEWS](#)
- [Package README](#)

Build package
Create package pdf manual
Build README
Run

Uninstall

OVERVIEW SECURITY

VERSION	LICENSE
2.5.2 (latest)	MIT

METADATA

Source repository	CRAN
Date published	2026-04-30
Interpreter	R 4.6.1

CONSOLE TERMINAL PROBLEMS OUTPUT PORTS

~/work/positron-workshop-project 163MB

> |

Quarto: 1.10.18

devtools 2.5.2 Reference Articles News

devtools

The aim of devtools is to make package development easier by providing R functions that simplify and expedite common tasks. [R Packages](#) is a book based around this workflow.

Installation

```
# Install devtools from CRAN
install.packages("devtools")

# Or the development version from GitHub:
# install.packages("pak")
```

LINKS

- [View on CRAN](#)
- [Browse source code](#)
- [Report a bug](#)

LICENSE

- [Full license](#)
- [MIT + file LICENSE](#)

COMMUNITY

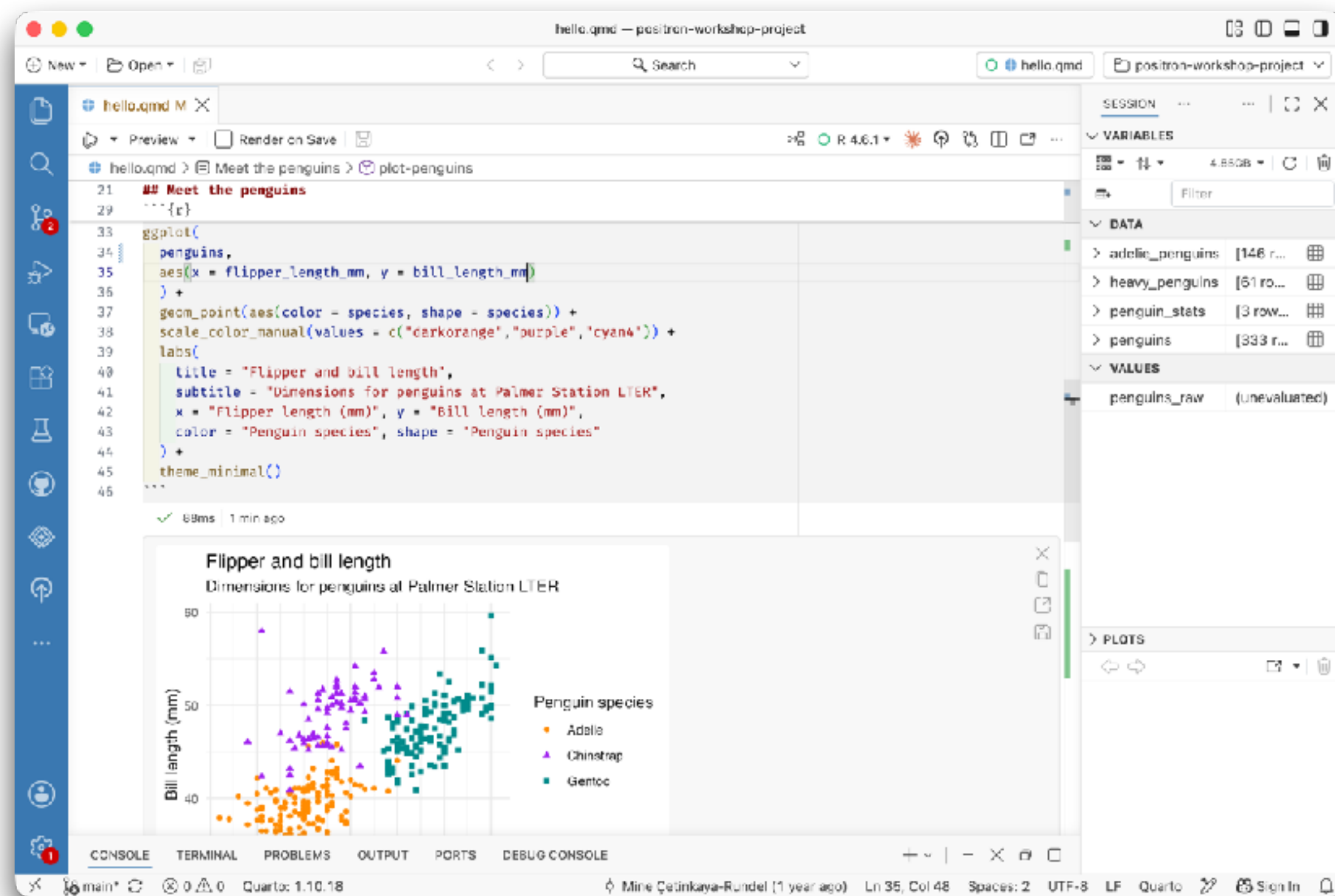
- [Contributing guide](#)
- [Code of conduct](#)

CITATION

- [Citing devtools](#)

DEVELOPERS

- Hadley Wickham



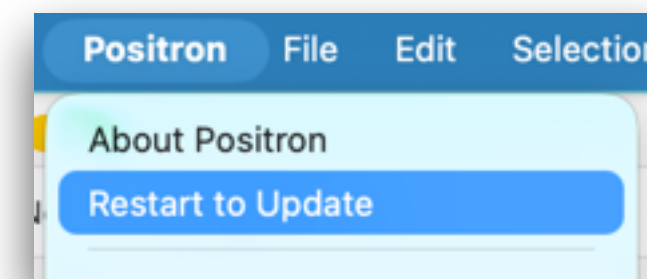
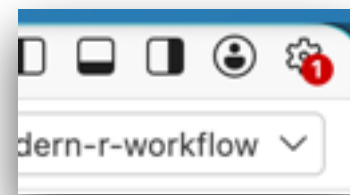
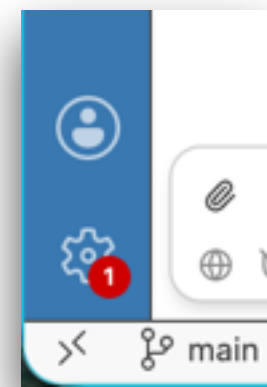
- By popular demand!
- Quarto inline output debuted in the 2026.05 release
- Enable via the [quarto.inlineOutput.enabled](#) setting.

Many other recent developments

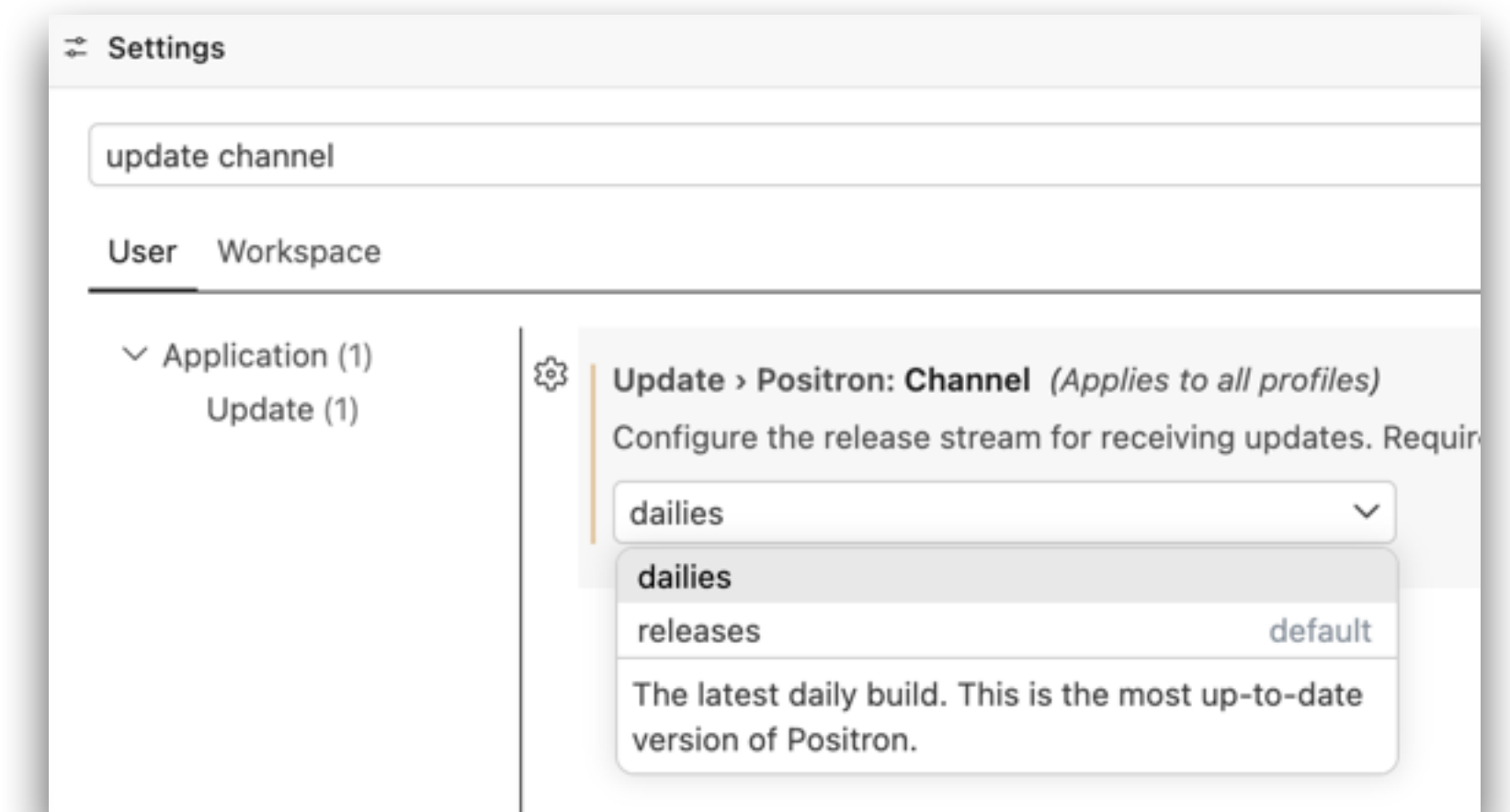
- <https://opensource.posit.co/blog/?q=source:positron>
- R debugging: breakpoint support
- Data connections
- R language intelligence
- "Import Data" support

Keeping up-to-date

- Positron automatically checks for updates. Accept that nudge!



- Setting: Update > Positron: Channel
 - **releases**: stable, monthly-ish releases, same version as on download page.
 - **dailies**: ~every day, cutting edge



Getting help

- Positron Docs: <https://positron.posit.co/>
- Ask questions on GitHub discussions: <https://github.com/posit-dev/positron/discussions>